

How to Take Your Client's Measurements

The 14 corset and lingerie measurements, how to take them and the printable sheet (cm and inches).

PART 1

Before measuring

So the measurements are useful.

Get ready

- ☐ A sewing tape measure in good condition (old plastic ones stretch). Ideally one with cm on one side and inches on the other.
- ☐ The client wearing the underwear she'll wear with the garment.
- ☐ A ribbon or elastic to mark the waist.
- ☐ The printed sheet and a pen.
- ☐ A warm, comfortable space with a mirror.

With respect

Tell her what you're going to measure and why before you do it. Look at the tape, not the body, and don't say numbers out loud: write them down.

PART 2

The 14 measurements

What to measure and how.

MEASUREMENT	HOW TO TAKE IT
1. Bust	Around the fullest part of the bust, tape horizontal and not pulled tight.
2. Underbust	Just below the bust, where a bra band sits. Firm but not tight.
3. Waist	At the narrowest part of the torso. Tie a ribbon and ask her to move: the ribbon settles at her waist.
4. High hip	About 10 cm (4 in) below the waist, at the level of the hip bones.
5. Hip	Around the fullest part of the bottom, feet together.
6. Front waist length	From the hollow between the collarbones down to the waist, through the centre.
7. Back waist length	From the vertebra that sticks out at the base of the neck down to the waist.
8. Bust height	From the point where the shoulder meets the neck to the bust point.
9. Bust point separation	Distance between the two bust points.
10. Underbust to waist	At the front, from the underbust line to the waist.
11. Waist to hip (length)	At the side, from the waist to the fullest part of the hip.
12. Back width	From armpit to armpit across the back, arms relaxed.
13. Seated waist to thigh	Seated, at the front, from the waist to where the leg bends. Sets the maximum length of the corset.
14. Torso length (for bodysuits)	From the shoulder, down the front, through the crotch, and up the back to the same shoulder.

If the client measures herself

When you can't meet.

- Someone should help her: on her own the tape twists.
- Ask for a photo from the front and the side with the ribbon at her waist.
- Measure the main ones twice (bust, underbust, waist, hip).
- Ask her to say whether she measured in cm or in inches, and write it on the sheet.
- Always make a toile: with measurements taken remotely, the fitting matters even more.

SHEET

Measurement Sheet

Print one per client.

Client: _____ Date: _____ Garment: _____

MEASUREMENT	CM	IN	NOTE
Bust			
Underbust			
Waist			
High hip			
Hip			
Front waist length			
Back waist length			
Bust height			
Bust point separation			
Underbust to waist			
Waist to hip (length)			
Back width			
Seated waist to thigh			
Torso length (for bodysuits)			

1 in = 2.54 cm · 1 cm = 0.39 in

Next step

Print 5 sheets and practise the 14 measurements with someone you trust before your next client.